

large studios or workshops. There they did their own projects and also supervised the work of their apprentices. These were young students who had agreed to serve an established artist, called a master, so they could learn new skills.



Andrea del Verrocchio

Of course, not just anyone could become an artist's apprentice. A would-be apprentice needed to show enough talent to persuade a master to take him on. By now, Leonardo had been drawing for years, and his potential had convinced his father, Ser Piero, to see what could be arranged for his son.

One of these masters, the artist Andrea del Verrocchio, lived in Florence. At this time, it was necessary for craftsmen to master a range of crafts to be assured of constant work. Verrocchio was no exception and had many different skills—painting, sculpting, and working with precious metals, such as gold and silver.